SCORE COMPANION
P#8 User Testing Report

Team 08 | October 18, 2026

A formative usability study of reliable score access and contextual practice reminders.

Three anonymous participants are documented. This report distinguishes recorded findings from missing session logistics.

Executive summary

Three musicians completed the recorded core flow in a Wizard-of-Oz test: open an offline score, mark a difficult measure, add context, review it, and mark it resolved. Participants struggled to understand what a marker saved, how to reach practice review, and how to interpret the sparse score representation. The next iteration will prioritize realistic score context and explicit marking, note, and review actions. Offline availability and the resolved confirmation will remain. These are directional findings from a small formative sample.

Methodology

The recorded method was think-aloud Wizard-of-Oz testing with static prototype screens. Participants described what they saw and what they would tap; the team presented the corresponding states. Evidence consists of two anonymous observation forms and a preserved GitLab session record. The reported task-completion times are not full session durations.

User	Recorded segment or context	Completion	Task time
P1	Format-Constrained Score Navigator	Yes	2 minutes
P2	Reactive Score Annotator	Yes	1.5 minutes
P3	Musician using a tablet before practice	Yes, with confusion	Not recorded

Documentation limitations

The available records do not establish facilitator and observer attendance for each session, complete session timestamps, the exact task prompt read aloud, or recruitment details. Participant 3's behavioral-segment assignment and task duration are not recorded. A complete P#8 contribution breakdown for all team members is also absent. These details have not been invented or inferred as completed requirements.

Session summaries

Participant 1

P1 completed the task in two minutes but did not know where to tap in the score view or that Practice review followed saving. They asked how to add songs and whether display quality would improve. They wanted recognizable sheet music, song context, and a practice-note prompt. They would not use the current prototype because it felt convoluted and insufficiently interactive.

Participant 2

P2 completed the task in 1.5 minutes and tried Practice review before saving a measure. They questioned whether they were adding a correction or saving measures, described the interface as empty, and were unsure where an existing note came from. They requested clearer musical notation and note prompts, plus tuner/metronome tools. They saw value in offline access and difficult-part notes but would not use the current prototype.

Participant 3

P3 valued the offline-ready badge because rehearsal Wi-Fi was unreliable. They selected measure 20, but the next prototype state showed measure 24 saved. The preserved record identifies this as a prototype mismatch. They did not understand the star icon and initially returned to the library after saving. They later completed the cue and review flow, expected repeated measure marking, and found the resolved checkmark motivating. 'After rehearsal' wording conflicted with their before-practice use case.

Evidence: the complete P1/P2 observation document is reproduced in Appendix A; the complete preserved P3 session record is reproduced in Appendix B.

Pattern analysis

P1 - Score representation and visual context are insufficient

Participants 1 and 2 both asked for measures that look more like sheet music. Participant 1 said the view did not look like normal sheet music, and Participant 2 found the experience empty. Participant 1 also lacked the song context needed to interpret "unresolved passages." This is repeated feedback from two of three participants, so it is the highest-priority credibility and comprehension problem.

P2 - Saving and reviewing corrections has an unclear mental model

Participant 1 did not know to use Practice review after saving. Participant 2 attempted review before saving and asked whether they were adding a correction or merely saving measures. Participant 3 did not understand the marker icon and initially navigated back to the library. All three reveal uncertainty about the relationship among marker, cue, saved passage, and review.

P3 - Current copy is too narrow for the intended rehearsal workflow

Participant 3 found "add context after rehearsal" inconsistent with using the app before rehearsal. Participant 2 also wanted a clearer prompt while adding a practice note. The cue flow needs neutral timing language and explicit instructions.

P4 - Offline access and completion feedback should be retained

Participant 3 explicitly valued the offline-ready indicator. The same participant found the large resolved check motivating; Participants 1 and 2 also completed the core flow. These elements support the product's central promise and should remain.

P5 - Value is not yet differentiated enough

Participants 1 and 2 said they would not use the prototype in its current state: it felt convoluted, not interactive enough, or not different enough. Participant 2 suggested a tuner or metronome. Those tools are useful ideas but are not included in the next iteration because they do not resolve the core score-marking comprehension failure.

Implementation decisions

Priority	Decision	Evidence	Acceptance check
P0	Replace placeholder measure blocks with a legible, realistic score excerpt, persistent piece/movement title, and measure/section context in review.	P1, P2	A tester can identify the current piece, section, and marked measure without asking what it refers to.

Priority	Decision	Evidence	Acceptance check
P0	Turn the star into a labeled **Mark for practice** control; after activation, show the selected measure and an explicit **Add note** / **Review saved passages** next step.	P1, P2, P3	A tester can explain what was saved and reach its review from the confirmation state.
P1	Replace "add context after rehearsal" with "Add a practice note now or later," and show an example note prompt.	P2, P3	A tester understands that a cue may be added before, during, or after rehearsal.
P1	Support repeated marking in the score view and display a marked-count indicator.	P3	A tester can mark two measures and see both reflected in review.
P2	Retain the offline-ready badge and resolved confirmation, while pairing the latter with a concise next action.	P3	Offline availability and successful resolution are visible without obscuring the score task.
Deferred	Do not add tuner, metronome, social features, or AI correction detection in this iteration.	P2; MVP scope	Core score-to-review flow is comprehensible before scope expansion.

Build sequence

1. Update the score-view and review screens with real-looking notation and musical context.

2. Implement the explicit mark, note, and review states with clear labels.

3. Add repeatable multi-measure marking and marked-count feedback.

4. Conduct a future validation round focused on first-use comprehension of marking and review.

Project tracking and evidence

GitLab P#8 milestone: https://gitlab.com/ull-gitlab/453/fa26/fa26-team-08/music-project/-/milestones/3

Issues #17-#23 cover preparation, recruitment, sessions, observations, analysis, decisions, and reporting. The supplied October 18 tracker snapshot lists these issues as closed but unassigned and without issue-level due dates. Live GitLab status was not verified during this local report repair.

Source records: P8_TwoParticipants_Issues2-4.pdf; LOGAN_GITLAB_SESSION.md; P8_SYNTHESIS_AND_IMPLEMENTATION.md; the P8 Figma prototype PDF; GITLAB_TRACKER.md. Updated screens are optional under the assignment.

Appendix A - Original observation notes

The following pages reproduce the supplied P1/P2 observation PDF.

Participant 1:

- Segment: Format-Constrained Score Navigator
- Date: 10/15
- Task Completion: Yes
- Time to Complete: 2 minutes
- Hesitation Points: When viewing a page of music, he did not know where to tap.
- Wrong Turns: Did not know to tap “Practice review” after saving a measure for review.
- Questions Asked:
    - “How do I add more songs?”
    - “You said it’s just a demo, will it display better in the future?”
- Verbal Reactions:
    - “This slide doesn’t look like normal sheet music” with a negative expression
    - Raised an eyebrow at the “unresolved passages” section; “I don’t have any song context here.”
- Suggestions: Make the measures look more like sheet music, text prompt when adding practice notes.
- Would Use?: No. It’s “too convoluted”; not very interactive. Doesn’t add anything new.

Participant 2:

- Segment: Reactive Score Annotator
- Date: 10/16
- Task Completion: Yes
- Time to Complete: 1.5 minutes
- Hesitation Points: None in particular
- Wrong Turns: Tried to tap “Practice review” before saving a measure for review.
- Questions Asked:
    - “What’s the correction I’m adding? Or am I just saving the specific measures?”
- Verbal Reactions:
    - “It looks kind of empty.”
    - “I didn’t put this note down. Unless it was AI or something that did this…”
- Suggestions: Make the measures look more like sheet music, text prompt when adding practice notes. Add tools like a metronome or tuner in the practice menu to assist in the practicing process.
- Would Use?: “Not in the state it’s in.” An app dedicated for accessing music offline and the ability to note down difficult parts is useful, but “not different enough.”

Appendix B - Preserved Participant 3 record

The following reproduces the project's existing session evidence.

Logan GitLab Session - Downloaded Evidence

Provenance

Downloaded from GitLab issue #19 (https://gitlab.com/ull-gitlab/453/fa26/fa26-team-08/music-project/-/work_items/19), note by @lpb100, posted October 16, 2026 at 11:14 PM CDT (October 17, 2026 at 04:14 UTC). This is preserved as source evidence for P#8; the participant is referred to only as Participant 3.

Session record

Participant 3 opened the tablet prototype before a practice. They noticed and liked the OFFLINE READY badge because their stadium and rehearsal-hall Wi-Fi is poor. They selected Open score for "Movement I - Percussion."

On the score viewer, they saw the previous/next controls, page indicator, Section B selector, and measures 17-24. They said they would tap measure 20. The prototype then displayed a saved state for measure 24; the participant treated this as a prototype mismatch rather than the intended selection.

The participant did not understand the corner star immediately: "I don't know what that is supposed to be." After the saved message, they tried Score Library rather than proceeding to the cue flow. On the following screen, they selected Save cue and review. In the review screen, they understood that the measure had been saved and said it would be useful before practice to work through difficult measures. They liked the final resolved state: "I like this big green checkmark telling me that the measure is resolved. That makes me feel like I accomplished something."

In post-task discussion, the participant said tapping could be confusing initially but, once learned, could be better than pencil marking. They found "add context after rehearsal" too specific because they anticipated using the app before rehearsal. When asked about several corrections, they expected to tap multiple measures.

Evidence coding

Observation	Evidence category	Implication
Offline badge was valued	Positive / preserve	Keep offline status visible in the library.
Star marker was unclear	Affordance / label	Replace it with a labeled action and a brief first-use cue.
"After rehearsal" wording conflicted with intended use	Copy / mental model	Make the cue flow usable before, during, or after rehearsal.
Multiple-measure behavior was expected	Capability	Support multi-select or a clearly repeatable marker action.
Resolved confirmation was motivating	Positive / preserve	Retain the clear completion state.

Privacy note

No real name, contact information, or identifying details are retained in this local copy. The original GitLab note is quoted only in short excerpts needed to preserve the testing evidence.